

DILLORA BY KASHVIN

Deployment Guide

Pull the latest code and take it live

For the developer

What this is

This is a short, repeatable checklist for putting the latest code live. The project has three parts that each deploy separately: the **Backend API**, the **Storefront** and the **Admin dashboard**.

Important context: the MongoDB cluster previously had data split across two databases, **test** and **dillora**. The app now pins the database name to **dillora** in code, and all correct data lives there. Just redeploy and confirm the boot log.

Step 1 — Pull the latest code

On main:

```
git checkout main
git pull origin main
```

Step 2 — Check environment variables

Env vars live in each **hosting account** (Vercel / your backend host), NOT in the code. A pull does not change them, so verify these are set:

Backend host

MONGO_URI	Atlas connection string. Include /dillora, e.g. ...mongodb.net/dillora?...
MONGO_DB_NAME	Set to dillora (belt-and-braces — the code defaults to it anyway).
JWT_SECRET	Existing long random secret (unchanged).
CLOUDINARY_* / RAZORPAY_* / SMTP_*	As already configured.
FRONTEND_URL	Comma-separated allowed origins (store + admin URLs) for CORS.

Storefront (Vercel)

NEXT_PUBLIC_API_URL	The deployed backend, e.g. https://api.yourhost.com/api
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Admin dashboard (Vercel)

NEXT_PUBLIC_API_URL	The deployed backend API base.
NEXT_PUBLIC_STORE_URL	The deployed storefront URL. REQUIRED — else admin product thumbnails 404.

Step 3 — Redeploy all three

- **Backend** — redeploy on your host (or it auto-builds on push, depending on setup). Restart is required so the new schema + DB-pinning code load.
- **Storefront** — Vercel redeploy (auto on push to main, or click Redeploy).
- **Admin dashboard** — Vercel redeploy.

Step 4 — Verify

1. **Backend database.** Check the backend boot log. It must say:

```
[db] Connected to MongoDB database: "dillora"
```

2. **Smoke test the live site:**

- Open the storefront home — the green WhatsApp button, promo banner and countdown show.
- Open a product page — colour dropdown + How-to-Order popup appear.
- Log into the admin dashboard — Overview shows real numbers; product thumbnails load (not broken).
- Place a test COD order on a mobile-cover product, then delete it from the dashboard.

The database, explained

Why data looked inconsistent before: some Atlas connection strings omit the database name, which makes MongoDB silently use a database called **test**. Production had been writing there, while other work went to **dillora**.

- The connection code now forces dbName = dillora, so this can never happen again.
- All real data (products, orders, brands, colours, popups, banner, settings) has been consolidated into dillora.
- A JSON backup of both databases was taken before consolidating.

Do NOT drop the **test** database until the redeploy is confirmed working on dillora. If any orders were placed on the live site during the switch-over, copy them from test to dillora first.

Troubleshooting

Store looks empty / old data	Backend not on dillora. Check MONGO_URI has /dillora (or MONGO_DB_NAME=dillora) and the boot log.
Admin thumbnails broken (404)	Set NEXT_PUBLIC_STORE_URL on the dashboard project, then redeploy.
Changes not visible	The relevant app wasn't redeployed, or the browser is cached — hard refresh (Ctrl+Shift+R).
Backend won't start	Wrong MONGO_URI / IP not whitelisted in Atlas -> Network Access.

Local development, for reference:

git pull -> npm install (in each app) -> restart backend + npm run dev. Restart the backend after any schema change so it reloads.